

Search sheets: how to run the activity



The pages after this one are 17 **search sheets**, built from *The Tale of Peter Rabbit* by Beatrix Potter. Print them one-sided and hand out **one sheet per person** — every sheet is different, and nothing needs cutting out.

Each sheet holds 66 **token pairs**. A **token** is one word or one punctuation mark; a token pair is a **next token** paired with the **previous token** that came immediately before it somewhere in the original text.

In **for supper**, the boxed token is the previous token and *supper* is the next token. Each token keeps the same colour wherever it appears, so scan by colour first and read second. With only 11 colours and far more tokens than that, a colour narrows the search rather than settling it — always check the token itself.

Say the colour when you call a token out — “who has *supper*? it’s a teal one” — and the room can find the swatch before reading a word:

black red brown ochre green teal blue navy violet purple wine

Running a round

1. **Call out the last token** of the text so far.
2. Everyone scans their own sheet for token pairs whose previous token matches. **Hands up** — one hand each, and anyone with more than one match just goes with the first they spot.
3. **Pick a raised hand at random** and ask for that token pair’s next token.
4. A scribe writes the token on the board. That token becomes part of the context for the next round. Repeat.

Worked example

Start anywhere. Pick any token pair — say this one — and write its previous token *and* its next token on the board.

Round 1. Call out the last token on the board (*supper*). Another sheet has a match, so that person raises a hand and reads out ..

Round 2. Call out the last token on the board (.). Another sheet has a match, so that person raises a hand and reads out *Peter*.

Keep going for as long as you like. The text the room writes will sound like *The Tale of Peter Rabbit* without ever repeating it — that is the model generating, not the corpus being read out.

Picking at random matters. If you take whoever shouts first you are sampling the fastest reader, not the text — and the whole point is that the room samples the way the model does.

What to watch for

The hands are the probability distribution. Every token pair was dealt to exactly one person, and the deal spreads each context across as many people as it will go, so a common continuation really does put more hands in the air than a rare one. Nobody has to explain weighted sampling; the room performs it. (Roughly: for a context more common than the class is big, somebody holds two matches but raises one hand, which flattens the busiest contexts.)

Nobody holds the model. No single sheet can continue the text on its own. The model only exists across the whole room — and if somebody is away, their share of it is missing, and some contexts will draw no hands at all.

Running dry. If no hands go up, you have reached a context that only ever occurred at the very end of the text. Start again from any token pair.

1123 tokens, 388 unique · 2.25 bits/token · perplexity 4.8 · branching factor 2.32

the token pair that answers

for supper

supper .

Peter

on the board

for supper

for supper .

for supper . Peter

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "for", then the token pair **for** **supper** is a match and you answer **supper**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

for supper	was the	if he	tired that
, scratch	crow to	on his	he got
the gate	there ;	, and	Mr.
and calling	towards Peter	very fast	carrying peas
some black	. Peter	such a	Peter scattered
time there	net ,	, who	planting out
, went	. his	lost one	, carrying
quietly off	a rake	twitched as	McGregor was
little bunnies	. then	scritch .	frightened ;
noise of	thing to	but Flopsy	cat was
to bed	to Peter	a dose	his water
the floor	was busy	he might	it was
blackbirds .	into mischievous	the shoes	wood .
jumped into	and milk	and climbed	flopped down
rabbit took	room for	never stopped	had bread
. Flopsy	Kertyschoo !	among the	potatoes .
garden .	radishes ;		

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "was", then the token pair **was** **after** is a match and you answer **after**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

was after	sand bank	Peter was	. rabbit
, leaving	he saw	a very	. rabbit
towards the	the baker's	and got	had done
McGregor caught		too small	alive .
over carefully	very quietly	to frighten	pair of
the least	for some	ate some	, Cotton
time ,	it was	much water	a window
whom should	on the	and jumped	most dreadfully
into the	if it	fortnight !	way to
he tried	old mouse	speaking to	tea ;
jumped up	to Mr	took a	. his
an old	the nice	slipped underneath	
. Peter	was very	little rabbit	squeezed under
some parsley	Peter ,	Flopsy ,	there were
, and	along ,	Mr .	garden :
, but	thing he	stone doorstep	and looking
but suddenly	root of	his cousin	no time

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "find", then the token pair **find his** is a match and you answer **his**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

find his	the gate	garden ,	Peter ;
but don't	had lost	was tired	, and
gold fish	old Mrs	time .	his mother
along a	would have	ate some	a gooseberry
in great	the large	staring at	, and
into the	over the	of breath	bushes .
little Rabbits	and then	and beyond	bunnies ,
for he	way straight	say that	McGregor .
floor of	no room	. then	Flopsy ,
it best	an accident	lane to	to look
very damp	Peter ,	, and	some gold
. McGregor	. McGregor	sitting in	still ,
began to	on four	umbrella ,	was out
locked ,	, and	the bushes	he was
running or	. but	to squeeze	he went
least idea	Mr .	you may	rake and
a wheelbarrow	sand on		

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "to", then the token pair **to him** is a match and you answer **him**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

to him	altogether if	somewhere in	he found
was the	Bunny .	had not	for a
I think	some camomile	Peter thought	running after
pie by	lane ,	McGregor hoeing	
, and	a sand	a pond	began to
without speaking		very naughty	to go
carefully ,	old Mrs	, if	and the
, and	water in	on his	by some
Peter asked	the window	safe at	in a
four legs	the tool	his hands	and out
Flopsy ,	. Mr	, Mopsy	. McGregor
Mr .	over the	only shook	garden ,
tool shed	into Mr	it .	sorry to
he became	bushes .	eyes .	my dears
turn them	way to	Also he	. Peter
of a	caught sight	the wood	was so
. Also	amongst the	time he	came up

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "might", then the token pair **might** **have** is a match and you answer **have**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

might have	he ate	began to	very still
sobs were	jacket .	garden ,	, and
was somewhere	Peter ,	came to	some French
to turn	French beans	dears ,	way back
Mr. .	the tip	Peter sat	sight of
great excitement		it was	the evening
what he	by the	cans .	in it
running in	bread and	under each	water cans
caught by	and Peter	the little	, and
a cucumber	and Cotton	, and	four little
I am	plants .	top of	, and
tool shed	she only	climbed upon	hung up
wall ;	nothing happened		Father had
had an	across the	was staring	over .
. but	his work	beans ;	. it
for a	a pie	to his	of his
. he	perhaps hidden	McGregor ,	he could

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "the", then the token pair **the** **blackbirds** is a match and you answer **blackbirds**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

the blackbirds	brown bread	baker's .	bed time
more and	shed ,	to exert	Peter had
she sat	through the	tool shed	Peter was
about ,	came out	. McGregor	the wood
a scare	out young	his shoes	Cotton tail
very big	, and	bread and	feeling rather
, going	McGregor hung	Mr .	all round
gooseberry net	of running	was turned	the other
hoeing onions	sieve ,	he rushed	a time
but now	. McGregor	for lost	by Mrs
Mrs .	beans to	, but	, but
answer .	. an	; and	and pair
it would	soft sand	he flopped	running as
at some	in the	under the	I am
one of	and some	buns .	jacket and
filled his	their names	: but	round .
to say	fast as		

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "the", then the token pair **the top** is a match and you answer **top**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

the top	bed ,	Mr .	. McGregor's
quite close	was very	sparrows ,	, scratch
their mother	Cotton tail	at the	calling out
found a	very ,	the stone	about cats
or down	lived with	shed ,	fright ,
looked behind	tears ;	he heard	one table
and more	he had	all over	pond where
tried to	get into	: your	to hide
. Mr	just in	; he	loaf of
out of	she gave	his way	jacket with
Once upon	but Mr	gate ,	of shoes
to rest	. and	first he	the tool
a can	now run	Mrs .	Peter sneezed
Peter got	damp with	, said	meet but
straight away	round the	in time	and then
more puzzled	McGregor !	fast ,	, but
a time	, Mopsy		

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "who", then the token pair **who** jumped is a match and you answer **jumped**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

who jumped	became more	back towards	shed big
doorstep ,	peeped over	out of	a blue
outside the	Mrs .	off the	first thing
of Peter	was put	gate !	very well
don't get	quite sure	young cabbages	or looked
jacket and	McGregor's garden		he had
at last	the fields	said old	been a
going lippity	, along	cry .	the cabbages
. Peter	, you	in a	, but
Cottontail ,	Mr .	wondered what	straight walk
the wheelbarrow		; he	she wondered
but presently	and don't	scattered underneath	
tried to	to the	his eyes	waving a
and the	have been	. McGregor	now and
one morning	knees planting	. They	Stop thief
him was	shoes that	, ran	Peter did
foot upon	puzzled .	naughty ,	he was
to her			

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "the", then the token pair **the** **end** is a match and you answer **end**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

the end	shed ,	now my	. she
jacket behind	. McGregor's	rest ;	sure that
was safe	them ,	out .	, she
but Peter	at bed	don't go	mischief .
to the	; but	with their	back was
thief !	straight across	second little	, he
gate ,	he went	good little	and went
hidden underneath		not answer	have got
basket and	the garden	sick ,	as fast
shut his	, as	should he	shoes among
brass buttons	can .	were alive	upon the
and ran	who was	her umbrella	she could
his sobs	made some	, perhaps	a loaf
of a	him .	. McGregor	care .
! Mr	in the	Peter !	going out
close to	implored him	five currant	quite new
McGregor's garden		he intended	to be

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colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

gate .	she had	can .	and trembling
and squeezed	with sitting	, quite	he ran
buttons on	done with	squeeze underneath	
shoes for	he came	think he	not had
thought it	them over	back to	idea which
; and	fish ,	as if	up with
was running	blackberries for	corner ,	end of
lippy lippy	to go	, underneath	him till
gather blackberries		the garden	, who
lettuces and	large buttons	that Peter	in the
Peter wriggled	! one	his foot	were Flopsy
. now	after Peter	beyond him	her head
upon Peter	out just	but his	at him
ran straight	spoonful to	who flew	saw was
to cry	away altogether	a door	. presently
, upsetting	friendly sparrows		underneath .
well during	and knees	. I	of a
the wood			

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "lippity", then the token pair **lippity** **not** is a match and you answer **not**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

lippity not	he was	tail twitched	till he
underneath the	a straight	her the	as nothing
she bought	, who	to wander	and there
ran on	the second	; and	up the
with brass	, feeling	that Peter	buttons ,
of her	gate !	, and	were four
currant buns	hide in	in and	run along
who were	evening .	away without	taken at
was on	the potatoes	not very	large pea
upon a	after a	clothes .	but he
faster ,	and five	. after	him .
cousin ,	his back	supper .	. his
out ,	and was	wander about	window ,
stopped running		, waving	he slipped
blackberries :	Peter began	. he	to the
! I	back to	got caught	went back
nice soft	peas and	. he	

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "away", then the token pair **away** **to** is a match and you answer **to**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

away to	to pop	Mopsy ,	ran after
her family	out ,	were good	bought a
each .	but Peter	in that	window was
he began	sat down	himself .	. after
went faster	Peter never	currant bushes	, he
tail had	the gate	and made	was locked
him to	that he	up for	a fortnight
! Mr	r ritch	he was	to her
of him	fields or	his mother	run into
scratch ,	with fright	. Peter	got home
and he	; but	Benjamin Bunny	
. McGregor	after him	. McGregor	, which
had heard	down the	as he	, whom
underneath the	, but	did not	look for
morning ,	intended to	and started	cabbages ,
upon the	not unfortunately		turned towards
the corner	flower pot	work .	fir tree

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colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

Rabbits ,	Mopsy ,	and Cottontail	he came
then he	the rabbit	put him	mother was
with his	underneath the	and beans	go ,
, scritch	him ,	. it	. the
not very	, and	, looking	other shoe
scratch ,	his jacket	tree .	went to
leaving his	up and	sat very	bank ,
fir tree	looking all	himself up	! Peter
Peter gave	her mouth	he lost	down upon
of brown	upon a	got down	in a
pop upon	that I	but round	cabbages ,
tail ,	to find	scr r	door in
; but	the big	was a	to a
may go	out over	after Peter	were overheard
heard the	shook her	and shut	had such
. presently	a hoe	am going	. a
your Father	, who		

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "head", then the token pair **head** **at** is a match and you answer **at**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

head at	new .	Peter was	got away
, but	and she	. he	from his
heard about	had not	and then	! first
a white	ritch ,	of a	and tried
Mr. .	he began	breath and	underneath a
down very	him at	went back	camomile tea
, and	. the	frighten the	his clothes
looking under	cooking ;	put his	mouth that
am sorry	tree .	. now	asked her
accident there	; he	. he	, and
with a	but it	to him	big fir
the gate	the first	in ,	, very
mother in	then old	names were	go into
that she	presently Peter	a wall	flew to
not care	was no	milk and	forgotten the
McGregor was	Mopsy ,	after losing	he jumped
her ;	white cat		

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "be", then the token pair **be taken** is a match and you answer **taken**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

be taken	not the	rabbit to	blue jacket
behind some	mother put	the root	but Peter
could go	presently ,	sneezed Kertyschoo	
some radishes	went down	excitement ,	beautiful thing
They lived	wriggled out	he went	, Mopsy
to gather	table spoonful	his jacket	dose of
he had	. Mr	! Peter	rushed all
the lane	in a	. but	and he
the way	her tail	had so	go .
. it	, he	during the	; he
and blackberries		wheelbarrow and	
a sieve	, he	. Mr	that Peter
tip of	so much	was quite	a large
put in	little jacket	him in	overheard by
which he	Peter .	down the	then the
McGregor was	, Stop	of it	Mr .
it were	fat little	and shed	big tears
frame ,			

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colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

pea in	some lettuces	the lane	to the
, for	go away	but she	he meet
, so	he had	cucumber frame	
then he	; and	the garden	gave a
was Mr	rather sick	lost ,	went through
Peter .	could not	suddenly ,	where Mr
onions .	Mr .	the noise	it to
down to	busy cooking	in no	little Benjamin
pot .	losing them	. and	and implored
rushed into	behind him	a flower	McGregor filled
was too	presently ,	him in	small for
a beautiful	and her	which way	big fir
. McGregor	dreadfully frightened		into a
so that	wheelbarrow ;	that can	he was
, and	shoe amongst	. McGregor	exert himself
had forgotten	. she	of the	black currant
, and	and peeped	wood to	rabbit one

When the token called out matches the boxed token of a token pair below, raise your hand, and read out that token pair's **next token** if you're picked. If more than one token pair matches, just go with the first one you spot. (A token is one word or one punctuation mark.) For example, if the token called out is "gave", then the token pair **gave** **himself** is a match and you answer **himself**.

colour names: **black** **red** **brown** **ochre** **green** **teal** **blue** **navy** **violet** **purple** **wine**

gave himself	so tired	cats from	into a
and rushed	there was	. he	behind him
lost in	tired of	little jacket	scare crow
hoe scr	had not	happened ,	Peter ,
go into	walk behind	best to	some friendly
him to	. he	time .	McGregor came
, and	hands and	he ate	and went
if it	upsetting three	; she	, he
the gate	started running	. Peter	it had
the way	a basket	. Peter	was most
unfortunately run		the tool	mouse was
Mr.	, little	but he	parsley .
for Mr	three plants	a fat	legs and
and their	wood outside	, quite	then ,
in her	jumped out	to put	home to
rabbit hole	he had	was not	last in
family in	hole and	trembling with	